DoIT Fellow Finale

Summer 2019

SARAH GREISDORF

Digitizing Marriage Certificates

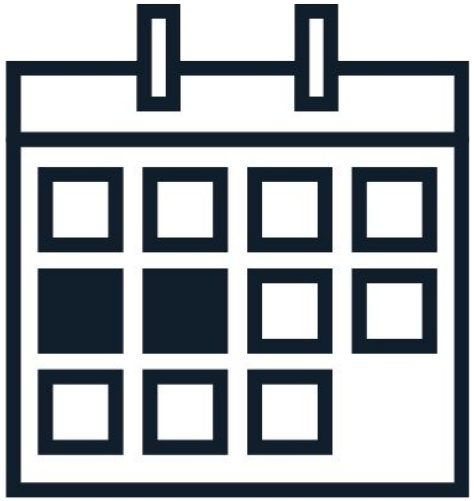
BACKGROUND

Death and Birth Certificates

- **Started with death certificates (March 2018)**
  - Began the relationship with the Registry Department
- **Brought birth certificates online (March 2019)**
  - Explored restrictions on certificates and spent time developing the UX that would serve as the basis for marriage certificates
- **Completed the vital records suite with marriage (Today!)**
  - Finished bringing all three certificates online, freeing up the Registry department to focus on new endeavors

RESEARCH

Questions going into the project



Dates

Additional Comments

Restrictions

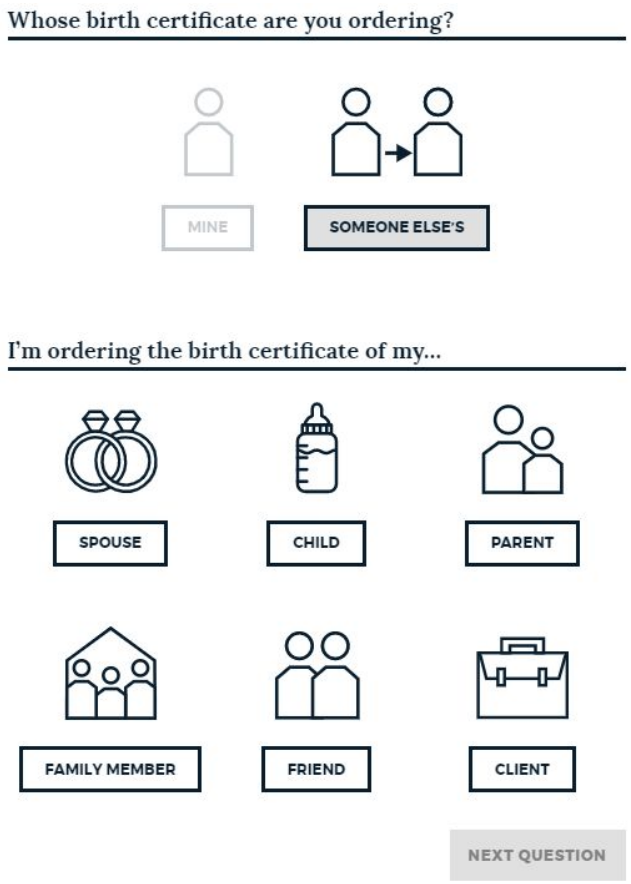
USER TESTING

Decisions Based on Data

- **Biggest Takeaways**
  - *Location, location, location!*
  - *Importance of providing context*
  - *Even if it's obvious to me, it might not be for everyone*

RESULTING PRODUCT DECISIONS

Person Identification



RESULTING PRODUCT DECISIONS

Date Ranges

What was the date of the marriage?

MONTH | DAY | YEAR

MM | DD | YYYY

▶ Not certain of the exact date?

→

Do you know the exact date of the marriage?

YES | NO

Please enter a date range.

The two dates should be within a five year period.

MONTH | YEAR — to — MONTH | YEAR

MM | YYYY — to — MM | YYYY

RESULTING PRODUCT DECISIONS

Name Page

1.

What is the first person's name?

It doesn't matter which person comes first on the marriage certificate.

FULL NAME

NAME AT BIRTH

2.

What is the first person's name?

It doesn't matter which person comes first on the marriage certificate.

FULL NAME

MAIDEN NAME (IF ANY)

3.

What is the first person's name?

It doesn't matter which person comes first on the marriage certificate.

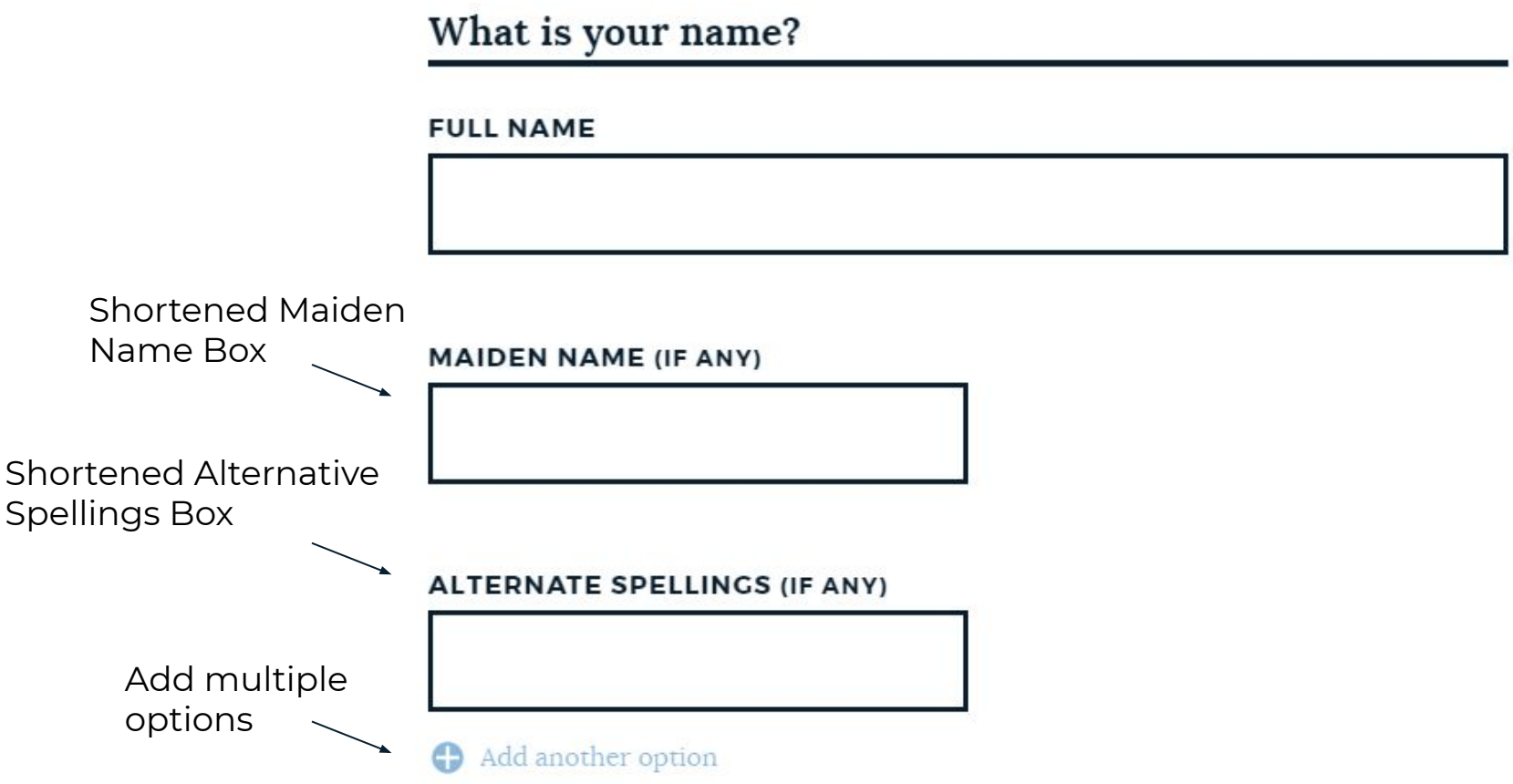
FULL NAME

MAIDEN NAME (IF ANY)

ALTERNATE SPELLINGS

RESULTING PRODUCT DECISIONS

Name Page



Outcomes

What's Next?

- **Changes being made to birth**
  - *Similar components from marriage can be simplified and improved in birth*
- **Alter apostille ordering process**
  - *Difficult to figure out how to order*
  - *Balance between being accessible and too easy to order*

CAROLINE KING

Digital Team Content Fellow

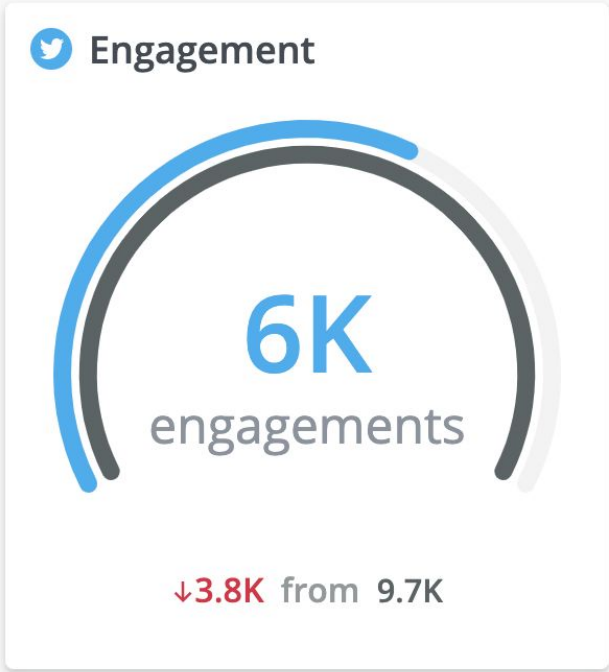
CONTENT CREATION

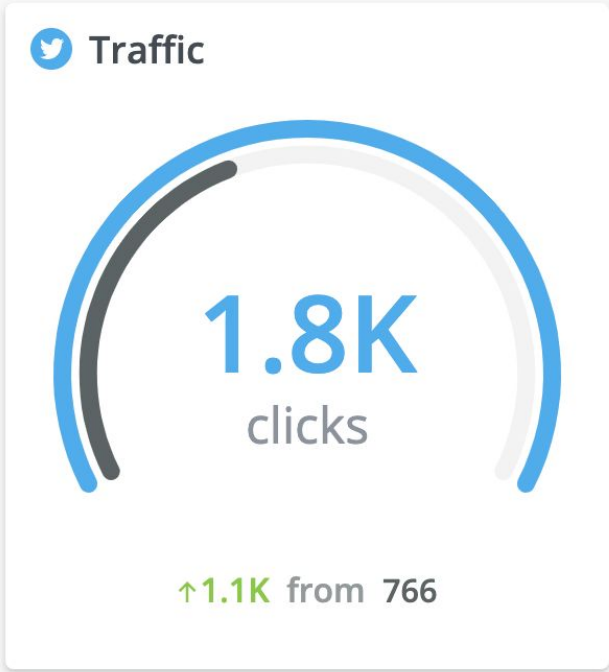
@CityofBoston

- **Summer Content Library**
  - *@CityofBoston Facebook and Twitter*
  - *100+ posts*
  - *Evergreen content*
  - *Scheduled 1-2 per day*

@CityofBoston Twitter Findings

April 15 - June 9, 2019 vs. June 10 - July 31, 2019

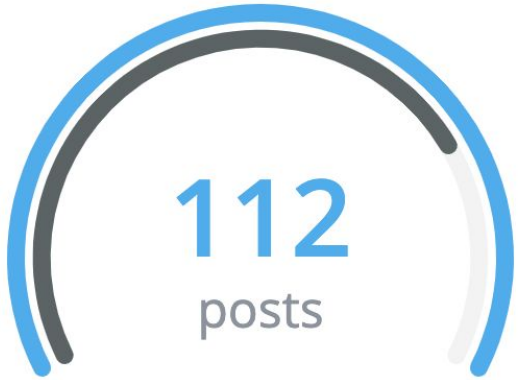




@CityofBoston Facebook Findings

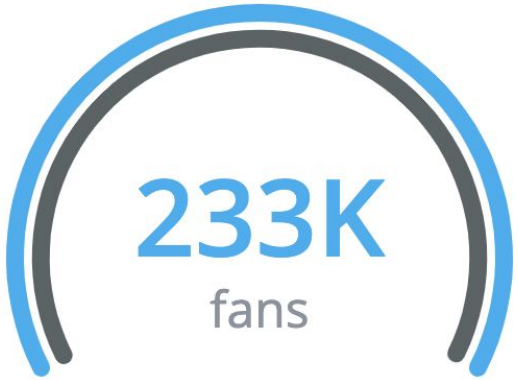
April 15 - June 9, 2019 vs. June 10 - July 31, 2019

Posts



↑27 from 85

Fans



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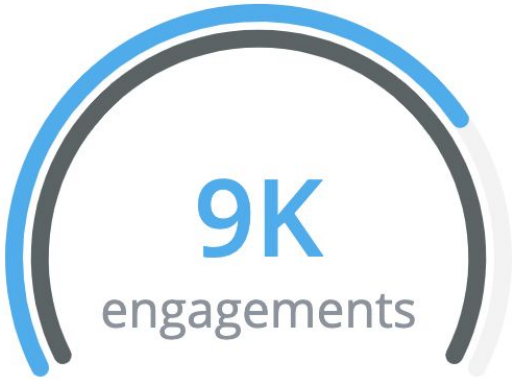
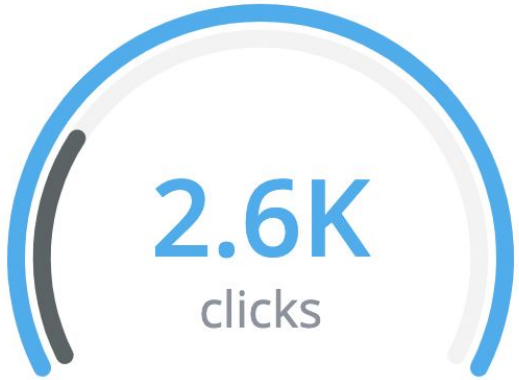
Engagement



↓3.1K from 12K

Traffic



↑1.9K from 695

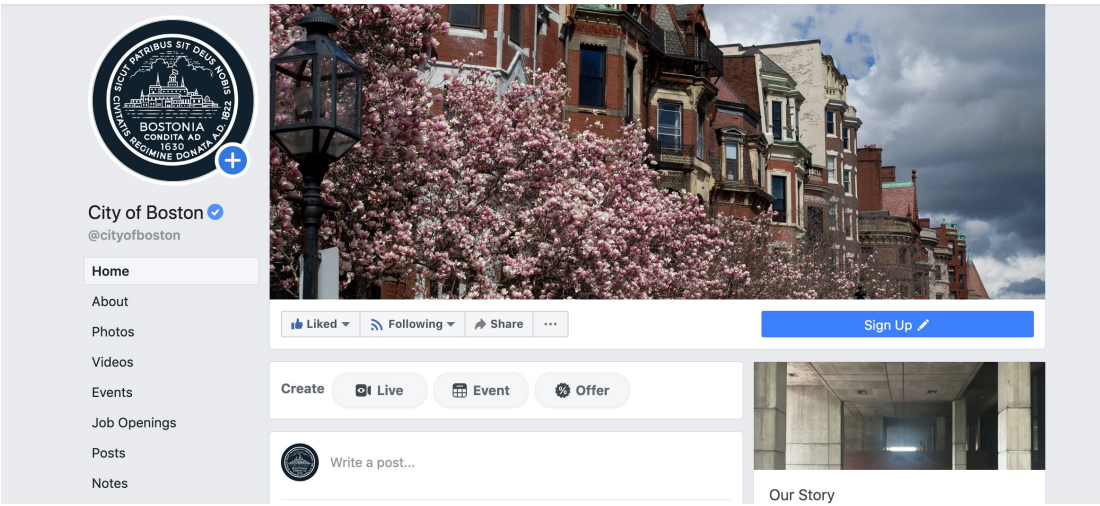
CONTENT CREATION

@DoITBoston and @VisitBoston

- **@DoITBoston Twitter**
  - *30 tweets in June-August*
  - *Highlighting DoIT's different teams and services*
  - *Creating a consistent posting schedule*
- **@VisitBoston Twitter**
  - *50 tweets throughout June and July*
  - *Highlighting Mayor's Office of Tourism, Sports, and Entertainment*
  - *Creating a consistent posting schedule*

SOCIAL MEDIA PRIVACY POLICY

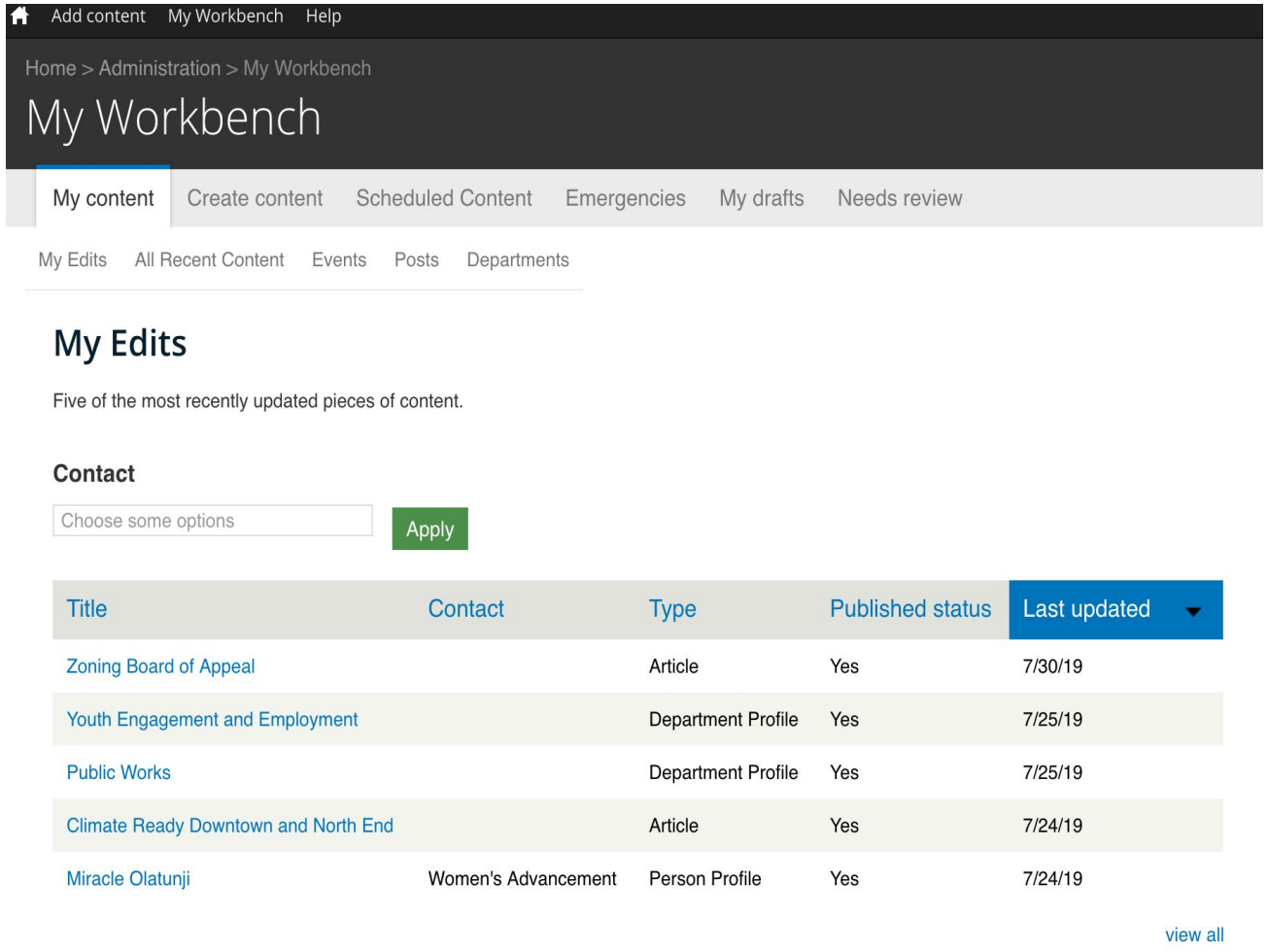
City of Boston



- **What are other cities doing?**
  - *Levels of Moderation*
- **What is Boston doing?**
  - *Discretion of the account manager*
- **What's next?**
  - *Public Records and the comment section*
  - *Government accounts*
  - *Guidelines*

BOSTON.GOV

- **Feedback & Editing**
  - *Tuesday/Thursday takeover*
  - *Responded to feedback emails*
  - *Push website updates on social*



TAKEAWAYS

Summer 2019

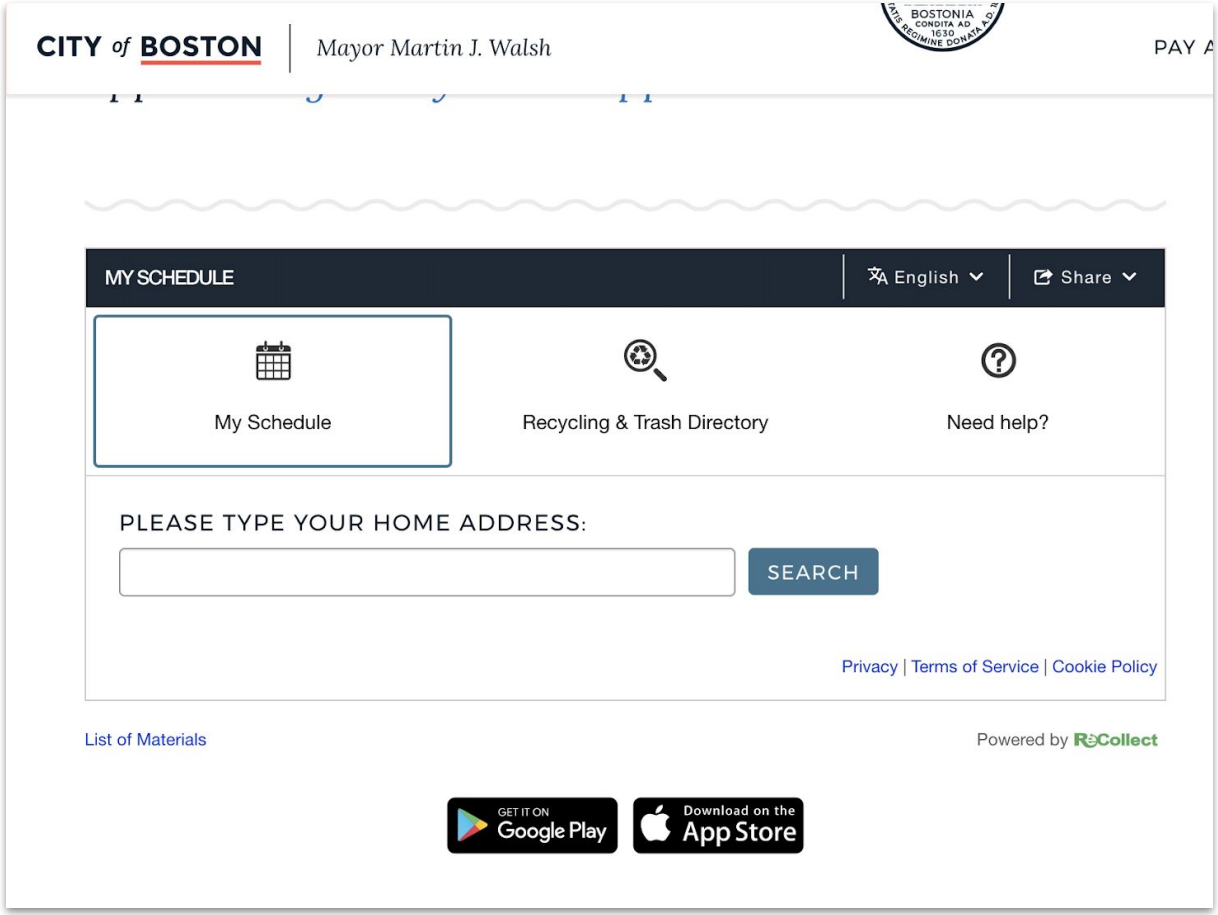
- **Accessibility**
  - *Reading level*
  - *Audience*
  - *Words matter*
- **Constituent Feedback**
  - *Responses (positive and negative)*

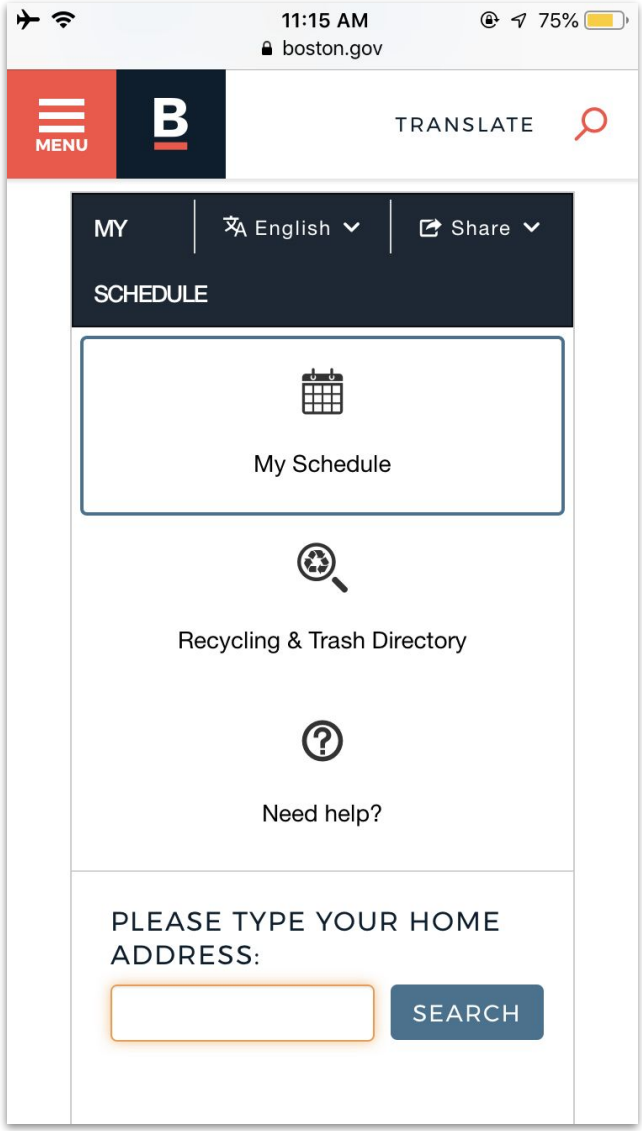
MAX BAHAR

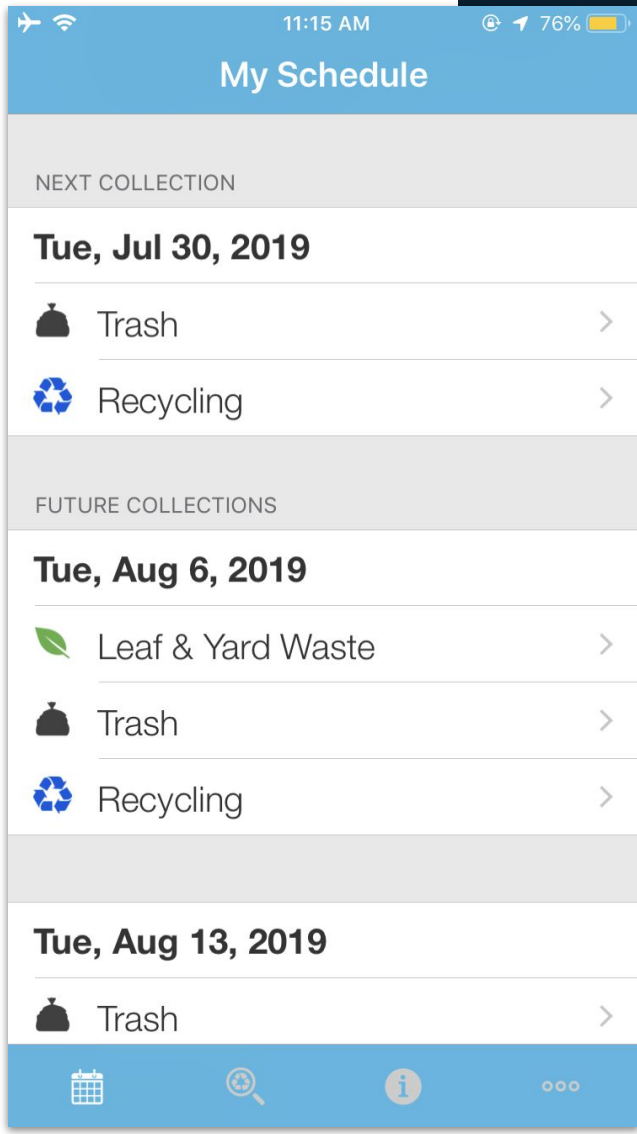
Digital Team Fellow

RECOLLECT'S TRASH DAY APP

What is it?







QUESTIONS

Who is using the app?

How are people using the app?

What features are people using/NOT using?

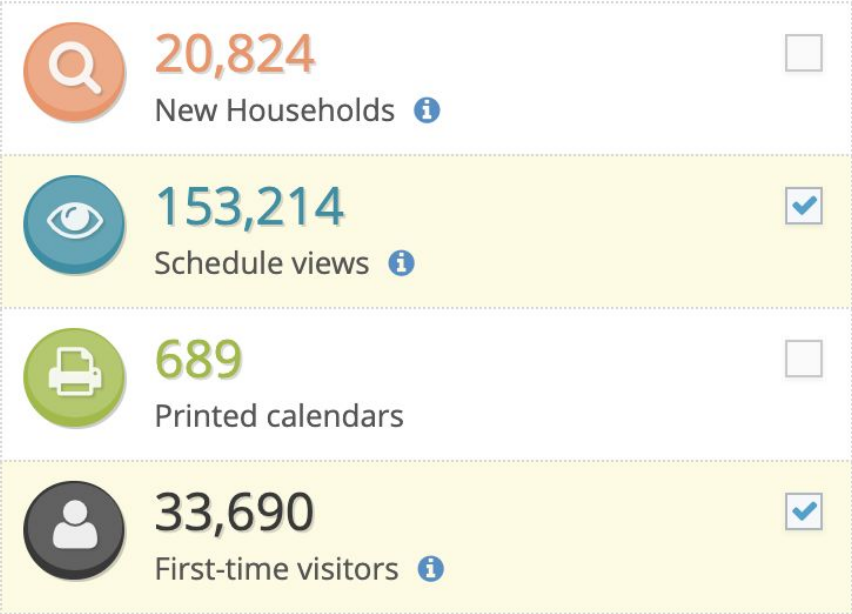
What features are WE not using?

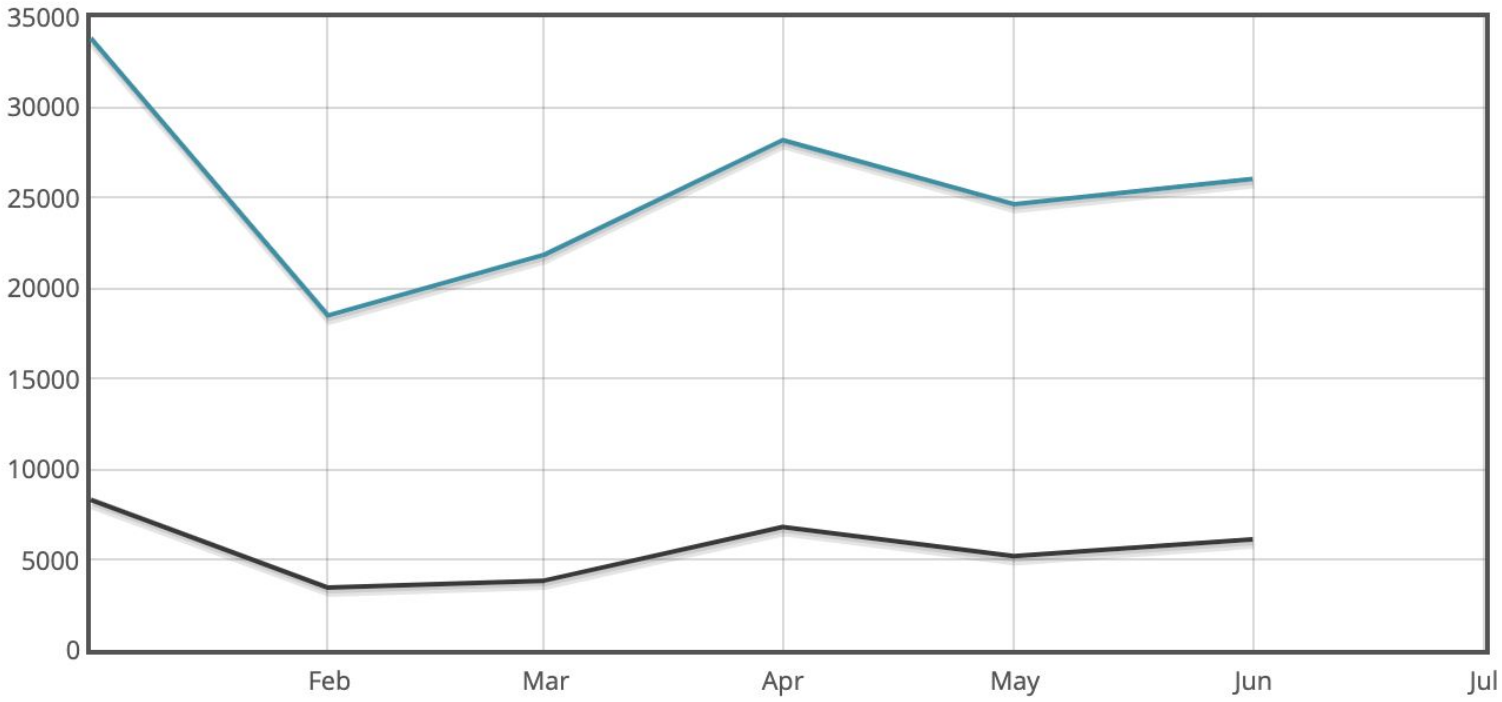
SHOULD WE KEEP IT?

The Big Question

USAGE

Schedule search analytics





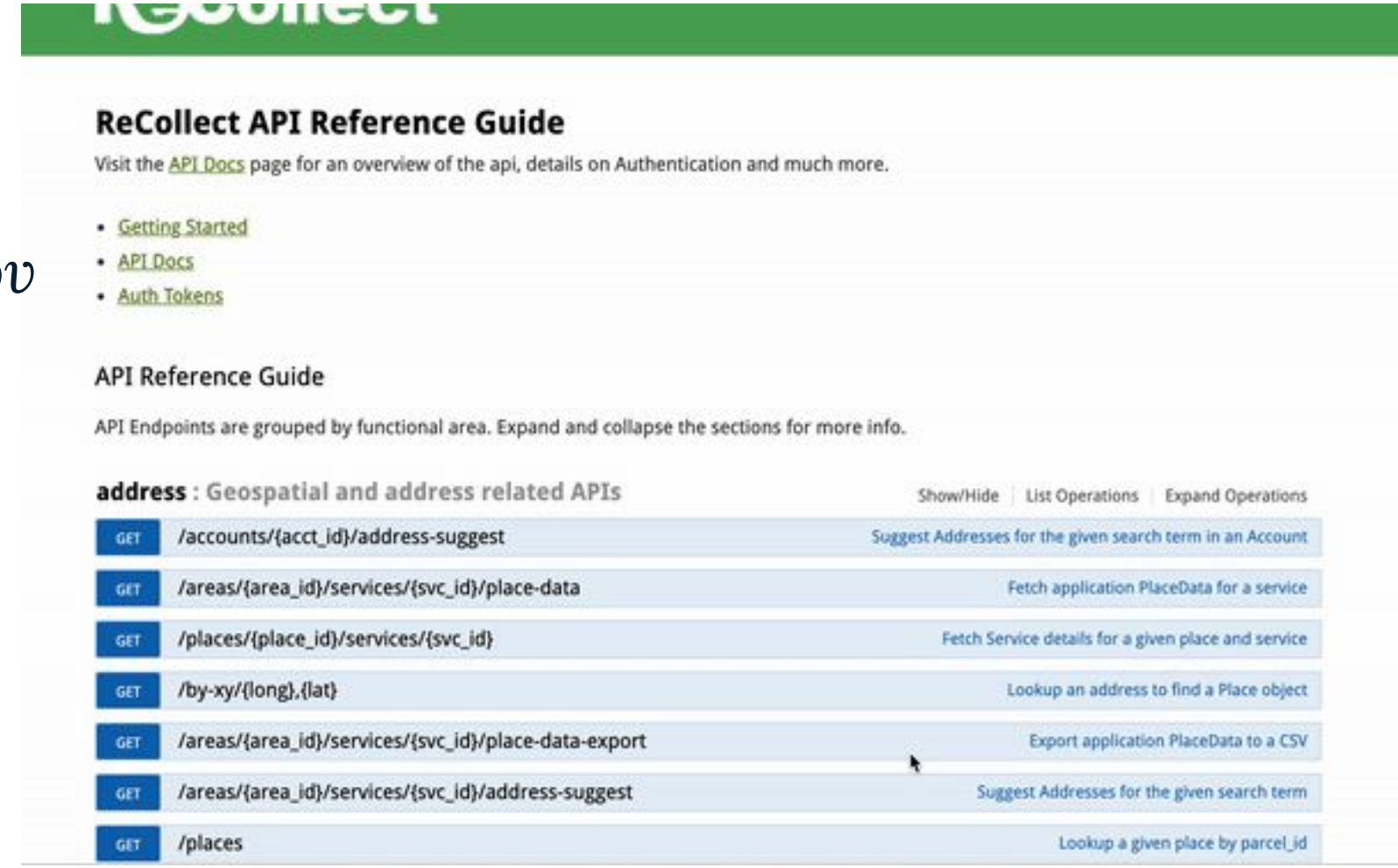
API

Lost Features

Automation?

Status Updates on boston.gov

Events on boston.gov



USER TESTING

Common themes

"Oh, I don't care about my pickup schedule, I live in an apartment."

"Oh! This looks very helpful!"

"Why should I download an app? I know when my pickup days are."

SURVEY

265 Responses

Biased: *A lot of responses from the South End, 1 response from Beacon Hill*

People don't really want ***weekly reminders*** *to take out their trash*

People mostly look to the ***internet*** *if they are unsure of their pickup schedule*

SHOULD WE KEEP IT?

The Big Question

LEARNS

Summer 2019

User Experience

Accessibility and Equity

Working in a municipality

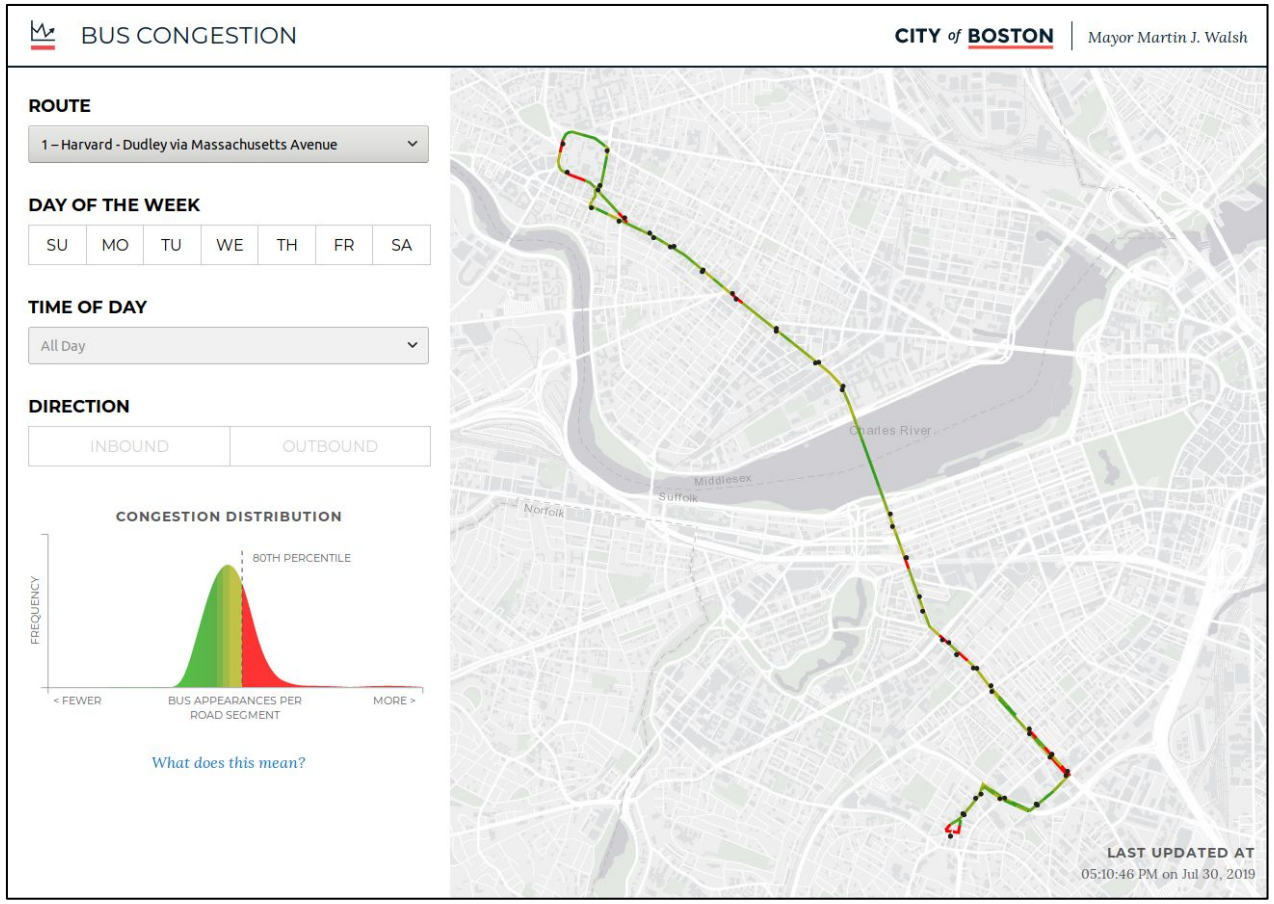
SINCLAIR TARGET

Analytics Team Fellow

VISUALIZING CONGESTION

Summer 2019

- **BTD's Need for Data**
  - *Adaptive Control / Bus Priority*
  - *Bus Lanes*
- **MBTA API**
  - *Public-facing API using common standard*
  - *Automated import process*
- **Proxy for Speed**
  - *Use fancy new GIS tools to group bus "pings"*
  - *Calculate distribution along routes*



TAKEAWAYS

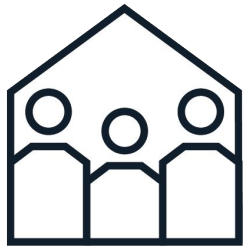
Summer 2019

- **Civis Platform + PostGIS**
  - *Make things easy*
  - *Nice tools to have*
- **Boston Brand Guidelines**
  - *Such a great idea*
- **Stakeholder Involvement**
  - *Feedback is important*
  - *Should be an ongoing conversation*

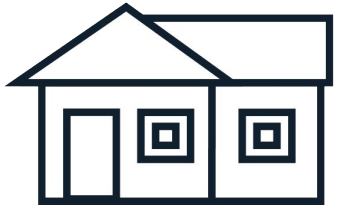
DANA ELLIS

Analytics Team Fellow

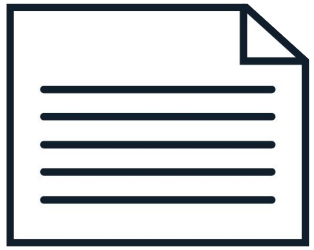
OFFICE OF HOUSING STABILITY



Coordination and Triage



Housing Stabilization Services



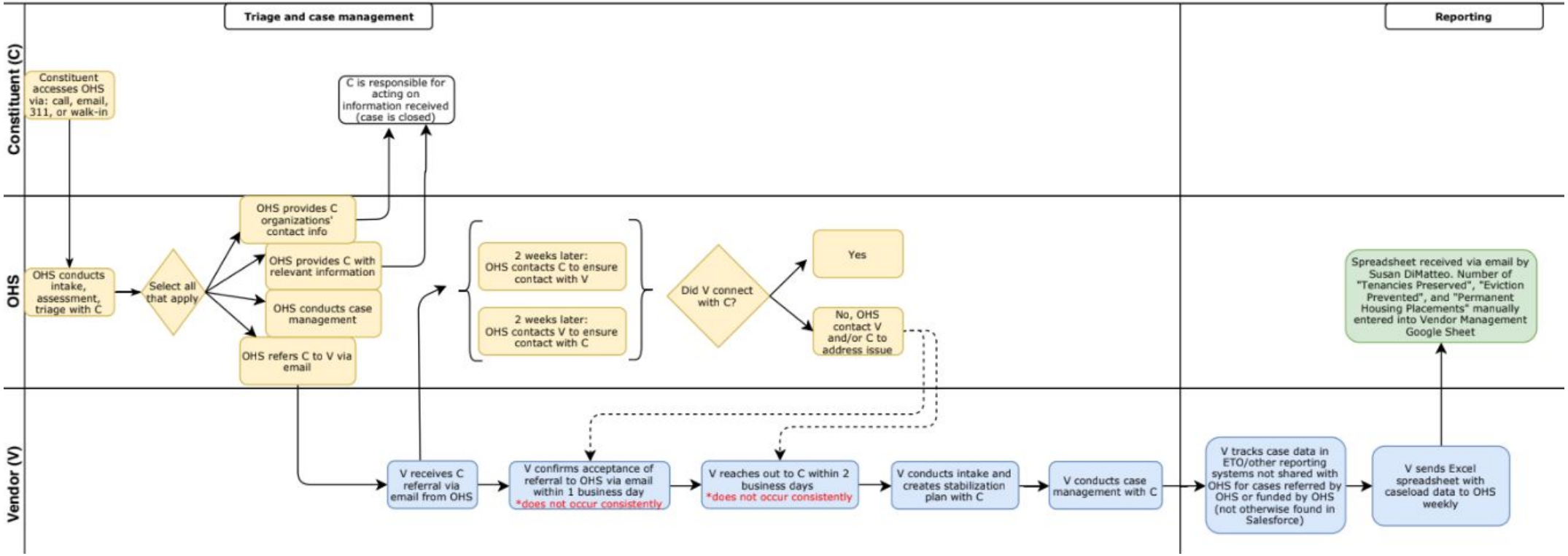
Informed Policy-Making

SCOPE OF WORK

- **Project goal:**
  - *Articulate and facilitate consensus on the social impact theory of stabilization services offered by OHS-- Why do we do what we do?*
  - *Identify output and outcome metrics to compare provider performance*
  - *Options and strategies for implementing performance management at OHS*
- **First step: Learning about OHS's work and processes.**

LEARNING PROCESS

- **Laying the groundwork for performance management**
  - *High level process map*
  - *Searchable contract spreadsheet*



LEARNING PROCESS

- **Laying the groundwork for performance management**
  - *High level process map*
  - *Searchable contract spreadsheet*
  - *Logic model with service descriptions, outputs, and outcomes*

	Outcomes			
Services	Make stable housing placements	Preserve tenancies	Prevent evictions	Everyone has a roof over their head
Emergency Shelter Services				x
Housing Search and Placement	x			x
Financial Assistance	x	x	x	
Landlord & Tenant Rights		x	x	
Landlord-Tenant Mediation		x	x	
Pre-Court Assistance		x	x	
Court Assistance			x	
Legal Assistance		x	x	
Voucher Retention		x		
Stabilization Case Management		x	x	

LEARNING PROCESS

- **Laying the groundwork for performance management**
  - *High level process map*
  - *Searchable contract spreadsheet*
  - *Logic model with service descriptions, outputs, and outcomes*
  - *Metrics for specific goals*

Service	Activity	Outputs	Short term outcomes	Long term outcomes
Financial Assistance	Victims of a disaster (fire, condemnation, etc) are eligible for flex funds to cover moving costs, or last resort short hotel stays. More broadly: funds may be used to cover rental or utility arrearages, security deposits, 1st/last rent, broker fees, or furniture costs.	Provides constituent with financial assistance resources Provides constituent with referral to financial assistance vendor - Metro Housing: Flex Funds: start up costs, arrears, broker fees - NOAH: start up costs - Other organizations: arrears Constituent applies for funding Constituent receives funding ($ amount) Constituent's financial issue is solved	Constituent connects with financial assistance vendors. Constituent receives financial assistance. Constituents arrears are paid.	Tenancy preserved. Prevent evictions. Reduce housing cost burden among residents. Make stable housing placement.

NEXT STEPS

- **Salesforce redesign**
  - *Implement approval workflow to streamline OHS and vendor communication*
  - *Standardize case statuses and closures*
- **Pilot new reporting strategy with two vendors**
  - *Bring them on to Salesforce directly OR*
  - *Roll out a new periodic report structure*
- **Learn from pilot; scale with remaining vendors**

THANKS FOR A GREAT SUMMER!